

SWING IN 3/4!

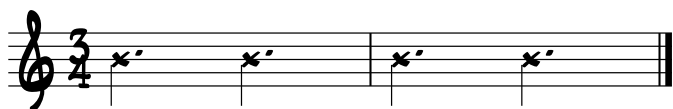
FROM DIGGING DEEPER JAZZ VIDEO #158

Why is it so uncomfortable to play in 3/4? We understand it just fine, right? Count to three! And we've certainly heard plenty of 3/4 songs like Someday My Prince Will Come and Bluesette. So, why is it so uncomfortable? Two reasons -

- 1) You shouldn't feel 3/4 in three (!), and
- 2) It's time to get yourself some rhythmic vocabulary in 3/4.

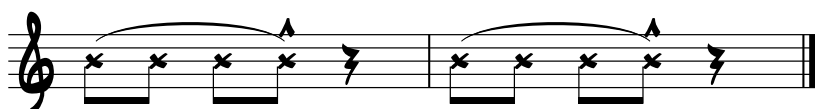
A jazz 3/4 feel should be felt in TWO, with two dotted quarter notes underlying each measure. For a Strauss waltz, definitely think "three quarter notes." Jazz is "two dotted quarters."

#1 - 3/4 Parent Rhythm



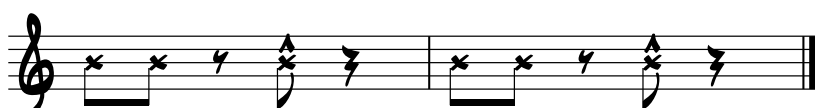
Here, we are thinking beat one, and the + of two. This brings some all important syncopation into the feel, not endless down beats.

#2 - Embellished Parent Rhythm



This excellent jazz rhythm is so good because it addresses the 3/4 Parent Rhythm. It "hits" one and the + of two.

#3 - Embellished Rhythm



This rhythm is very much the same as the rhythm above. It begins and ends the same, but has a rest in the middle.

#4 - Embellished Rhythm



A different embellishment of the Parent Rhythm, again highlighting beats one, and the + of two.

#5 - Embellished Rhythm



A more subtle version, where beat one is played as a rest. The + of two is the end of the phrase.